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Kratom Crazies: Hero complex and panic fuel poor legislation

Rep. Rob Beiswenger, District 8



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Kratom

Kratom (*Mitragyna speciosa*) is a tree in the coffee family, found in Thailand and neighboring countries. Traditionally, in Southeast Asia, people have chewed its leaves or made them into a tea that is used to fight fatigue and improve work productivity. Kratom has also traditionally been used during religious ceremonies and to treat symptoms such as pain and diarrhea, sometimes as a substitute for opium.

Two compounds from kratom, mitragynine and 7-hydroxymitragynine, interact with opioid receptors in the brain. People who use kratom have reported both stimulant-like effects (increased energy, alertness, rapid heart rate) and effects like those of opioids and sedatives

The media loves to manufacture a crisis and many politicians love to step in and save the day!



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People in Idaho have been using Kratom for years and even decades for arthritis and pain management, but also mood enhancement or withdrawal.

But this 2026 legislative session the hysteria got so intense that a House member drafted a bill to ban natural leaf Kratom statewide. It was added to Idaho's Schedule One List alongside meth, heroin and fentanyl.

KTVB recently ran this sensational headline calling Kratom "Gas station heroin": ['Gas station heroin': Idaho family shares warning after mother linked to potent kratom compound | ktvb.com](https://www.ktvb.com/story/news/health/2025/08/28/idaho-family-warns-kratom-compound-linked-to-potent-heroin/7744444002/)

The article opens up with a sad story about a 50-year-old woman who reportedly died after taking Kratom. However, you don't have to be on the Health and Welfare Committee to know that medical issues are complex.

To its credit, the KTVB article states that Ms. Boswell struggled with alcohol addiction during her life. So, it seems logical that her box

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But

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did not, a

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The truth is Kratom has been available to the public for decades. hearing and in preparation for the hearing to ban Kratom and 7-0 many people had taken natural leaf Kratom for up to 20 years wi

Why would we want to take natural leaf Kratom away from peopl helping?

Further, it is ironic that the people trying to ban Kratom highlight withdrawal is very dangerous, and yet that is exactly what they v

their ban.

And despite using that claim for political gain, proponents of the current kratom users nothing to help them withdrawal, effective out from under them with little warning.

There was a Senate bill sponsored by Sen. Tammy Nichols that v Kratom on a regulatory structure (like most other imported prod Kratom would be tested before distribution but the legislation w enough support before the session concluded.

Hopefully next January if the legislature takes up the issue we c emotional over-reaction and carefully listen to all sides.

By Rep. Rob Beiswenger, Republican, District 8, Member of the H Welfare Committee

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Lamborn For Idaho 6d

Loud mouth, wild eyed freshman 'Karen'... ignorant about kratom, com
benefits (and beneficiaries), just wanting to score political points... and
self-importance, as well as all that CONTROL that comes with being a

Please do all that you can to keep the stuff in Idaho!



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REPLY



Linda 6d

Ban the 7-OH but leave the leaf product COMPLETELY alone. Do not re
Senator Nichols is wrong on that point. Just leave the natural product

Senator Nichols is wrong on that point. Just leave the natural product as it becomes, regulate, test, tax. all government NON-FREEDOM. BTW, I do never have, but I have a friend who does take it and it helps her anxiety. anxiety, I would use homeopathics, but to each their own

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